



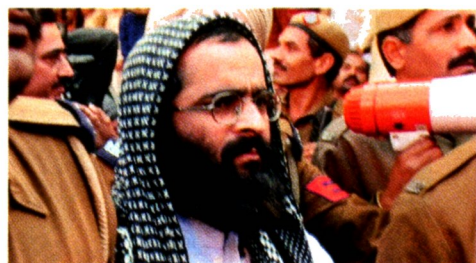
HEMANT CHAWLA

"I've been sincerely pursuing the middle way approach in dealing with China for a long time but there hasn't been any positive response. I have given up."

DALAI LAMA, Tibetan spiritual leader

"The CPI(M) is carrying a misleading campaign on the Indo-US nuke deal that the Government has sacrificed the country's sovereignty, which is utterly false."

PRANAB MUKHERJEE, external affairs minister



AP

"Verbatim"

Politicians and celebs love to shoot off their mouths, but mostly end up shooting themselves in the foot. Some memorable quotes from the year gone by.

"I am as old as Prime Minister Manmohan Singh. If he can run the country, why can't I run a state?"

V. K. MALHOTRA, BJP's chief ministerial candidate for Delhi



SIPRA DAS

"Life in confinement has left me half-dead. I plan to leave India though I would like to come back someday. As of now, I cannot take it any more."

TASLIMA NASREEN, exiled Bangladeshi writer

"I am working for the image of Gujarat. I don't have time to think about my own image."

NARENDRA MODI
Gujarat chief minister



SHAILESH RAVAL

"The UPA Government cannot reach a decision. I wish L.K. Advani becomes the next prime minister as he is the only one who can take a decision and hang me."

MOHAMMAD AFZAL, sentenced to death in the December 2001 Parliament attack case

"The message we want to give is that we can be hurt but can't be knocked out. We are happy the Taj Hotel has reopened, but we must remember the guests, the commandos who lost their lives."

RATAN TATA, chairman of the Tata Group, at the reopening of the Taj Hotel after the 26/11 Mumbai attacks